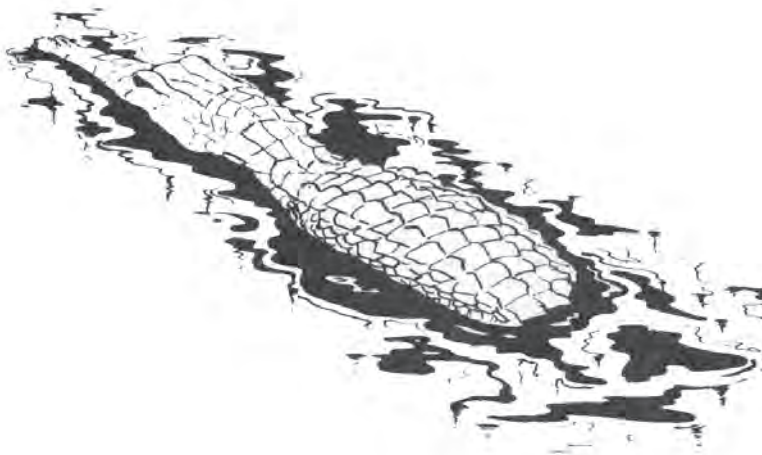




THE INTERVENING YEARS



The drum began its beat during the roaring '20s. Yesterday, the drum beat in the old tower room of the Anastasia Building. The drum kept up its slow steady beat through every season of the Great Depression.

Though not as loud, and only once each year, the drum pulse continued quietly into a world torn with war. And yet the drum persisted. The drum beat strongly beside each ritual fire of the '50s; it kept its haunting vigil through every year of man's great race to reach the moon. It beat again and again and again, sending its solemn echo through every withering year of discontent. And the drum continues to beat as strongly and insistently as ever.

It may be that the heartbeat set in rhythm by Tony Tommie will outlast his people and his culture. It is not the way we would have it, but it is the way things may turn out to be. The anguish is there in Dania today. And it is anguish that lurks out on the fringes of the Trail. It is a helpless anguish that must watch a wilderness and a culture die.

The drumbeat must not be stilled. It must be kept to haunt us with its primitive rhythm. It bestows an honor that has been sanctified by time; and it honors a culture and people that have taught us many things.

From the beginning, the tradition was passed down by word-of-mouth.





THE GREAT DEPRESSION

There was no written constitution, no written ritual, and no membership certificate. Here and there a scrap of paper would emerge, only to disappear again.⁶⁴

In 1931, Tony Tommie died. But the tradition continued. The Hurricane on May 11, 1934, reported “11 men were initiated by Iron Arrow around a campfire last Sunday night.” The tapings in these times were held in the rotunda of the old Anastasia Building. James Koger remembers that the “drums would start beating outside while classes were in session” and everyone would know that Iron Arrow was tapping. Tappees were usually tapped outside the classrooms when friends or faculty called them away on some pretext; yet Koger remembers actually going into the classroom to tap one student when other methods failed.⁶⁵

In the 1932-33 school year, Chief Cushman Robertson signed a small paper, one copy of which has come down to us, which was a bid to membership in Iron Arrow.⁶⁶ During these years, Dr. Ashe gave a dinner party for new tappees and financed the cost of a page in the *Ibis* for the society. Elmer Johnson remembers that the famous gangster, Al Capone, had offered the University a large sum of money if the City of Miami could be persuaded to allow him to remain here in a sort of political asylum.⁶⁷ Whether true or not, the flavor of the times rings true.

By 1936 it was reported that membership in Iron Arrow required at least a B average, but this innovation did not last. Yet the tribe continued to tap only nine or so new students each year; a number decided upon earlier by the



⁶⁴ - Harold Humm thinks he recalls a written constitution back in 1934 which he consulted in order to follow prescribed procedures. In his letter of December 26, 1974, he says: “It is unfortunate that this has not been handed down, even though it may be inadequate....I suspect it originated with Bowman Ashe and was probably based upon some men’s honorary with which he was familiar.”

⁶⁵ - Koger, James, Iron Arrow, 1933, phone conversation with author, January 3, 1976.

⁶⁶ - A copy of this bid is reproduced in the photographic sections of this history.

⁶⁷ - Recollections of Elmer Johnson, dinner conversation with author, Norfolk Yacht and Country Club, January, 1971.





founding nine.

And still the depression wore on. There were no dues and fees back then. No one could afford them. On May 13, 1937, Nu Kappa Tau was formed.⁶⁸ It was to be the highest honor attained by women. For years thereafter, Iron Arrow and Nu Kappa Tau were the brother and sister of tradition. The women wore their robes and an orange scarf about their necks. One was not mentioned without the other. Tappings were concurrent. Then, in the spring of 1966, Nu Kappa Tau chose another course, leaving Iron Arrow to carry the tradition alone.⁶⁹

There were two arrows made of iron all through these years. They can be seen again and again in photographs from the period. Neither one remains; the arrow in use today is new. George Rosner reports that by 1939, the wearing of masks at photography sessions had come to an end, but the tappings were still held at one of the weekly assemblies that students were required to attend. Most Iron Arrows were tapped at a special “honors assembly” in the spring semesters of their senior years, leaving little room for tradition to grow. These then were the lean years.

At least two interesting artifacts have come down to us from this period, however. In 1939, Iron Arrow member Wade Stiles (elected Chief, 1932-33) was diving on the bottom of the Atlantic near Caryfort Reef in the Florida Keys. He found there a pair of rusty, 244-year-old cannons among the ruins of the H. M. S. Winchester, which had foundered on the reef in 1695 while en route from Jamaica to England. He successfully raised the ancient cannons and made a gift of them to the University. They stood among the moldy, musty vegetation in the courtyard of the Anastasia Building until the old college was demolished in early March 1968. One cannon now stands in front of the Memorial Building. The other guards the traffic circle between the School of Law and the Whitten Student Union, its barrel trained formidably on some isolated, distant target in the center of the Florida Everglades.⁷⁰

War came in 1941. Nightlife in the city of Miami changed drastically. As former Chief Harry Rinehart recalls, “We held our Iron Arrow meetings in the old Law School building. The drapes were drawn to aid the imposed blackout in the Miami area. Our cars had the top half of the headlights painted black.

⁶⁸ - The Miami Hurricane, May 13, 1937.

⁶⁹ - Nu Kappa Tau chose to become a local chapter of the national women's honorary, Mortar board, thereby forsaking its independence and retaining the Nu Kappa Tau name only as its chapter designation. Grade requirements and other tapping restrictions also altered the character of the society which had once recognized only on the basis of outstanding leadership and service. The Miami Hurricane, March 25, 1966.

⁷⁰ - The Miami Hurricane, January 16, 1953.





WORLD WAR II AND AN IRON ARROW POW WOW

The idea was to help reduce the amount of light in the Miami area because the illumination was silhouetting merchant ships, making them easy targets for the German U-boats that were operating off the Florida coast.

“The very future of the University of Miami was bleak. I shall never forget one incident. While walking across the patio of the main building one day in the spring of 1943, Foster Alter, Dean of Men, put his arm on my shoulder and said, ‘The future of the University is in doubt. We may not open next fall!’”⁷¹ At this critical time, many of the University’s most talented members were called away for service in the larger cause. Dr. Ashe took a leave of absence in order to serve as head of the War Manpower Commission for the Southeastern United States. Harry Rinehart remembers “Less than two years after graduation, I met several Iron Arrow members on a Navy ship half way around the world off the coast of Okinawa.”⁷²

Despite the stress that was placed on the University and its traditions, Iron Arrow continued. The Hurricane of February 5, 1942, reminded campus groups (I.A. among them) of their appointments for Ibis pictures the following week. It is interesting to note in passing that an article in the March 12, 1942, The Hurricane predicted a manned trip to the moon, someday. By May 7, the paper had announced the names of the new spring tappees for 1942.

By 1944, the war’s wear and tear on the tradition began to show. The February 4, 1944, edition of The Miami Hurricane ran an editorial entitled “We Need Iron Arrow.”

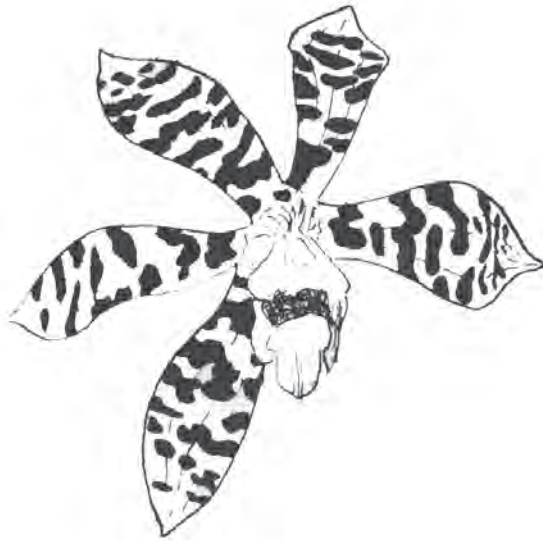
“There has been talk that Iron Arrow, highest men’s honorary, may discontinue taking in any new members for the duration.”

“Discontinuance of Iron Arrow, we feel, would be a mistake.... Surely the loss of the awe-inspiring ceremony replete with tom-tom, Seminole garb, and the Iron Arrow would be felt by students who have witnessed it before. And the students who have never seen the ceremony would be missing a well-founded tradition. In fairness to the student body, we ask Iron Arrow to think it over.”

The editorial evidently had an impact, for one week later, on February 11, 1944, the Iron Arrow - Nu Kappa Tau tappings were announced, with the comment that “Until today, there were no student Iron Arrow members on campus.” The initiation of these new members did not take place until late that spring, however, and even then in an unusual environment. The student paper

⁷¹ - Rinehart, Harry E., letter to the author, September 17, 1974.

⁷² - Ibid.



reported on June 2, 1944, that seven Iron Arrows were initiated “last night at the home of Hardin V. Stuart.” The fall initiation that year took place just prior to October 23, this time at the home of Seymour Simon.⁷³ Thus, though Iron Arrow certainly was not dead during the war, its traditions were clearly in disarray.⁷⁴

Despite (and perhaps because of) the hardships imposed on the tribe by the war, the founding members still returned regularly during this period to participate in, and even sponsor, tribal activities. One of these activities was a “pow-wow” held by Francis Houghtaling on Merrit’s Island in the middle of the Little River.

“Merrit’s Island was famous at the turn of the century for it exceptionally good-tasting citrus fruit. The land was homesteaded by Pete Merrit. . .and his improvement consisted of clearing the center of the island of mangrove jungle and planting citrus. He had a large packing house, or shed, full of fruit. He shipped carloads. Half the homesteaded land was under water, the bottom of Little River. Pete Merrit had built a log road of over 1,000 feet from the mainland to the island, with a bridge in the middle so the Indians canoeing downstream

⁷³ - The Miami Hurricane, October 23, 1944.

⁷⁴ - This reflects no discredit on members of the tribe during this period. Available information indicates traditional initiations could not be held since they would have interfered with a part of the war effort.





could get through.

“There were three camping sites around the edge of the island for the Indians. They were welcome to come to his shack and pump water, whether he was there at the time or not. His tools and possessions were never touched or disturbed, the shack never locked. The pump had been completely swallowed up by a fig-rubber tree. So actually water seemed to be pumped out of the tree. Another strangler-rubber grew out of the top of an oak and grew so high that the Indians used it as a landmark.

“It was under this tree that we had our Iron Arrow meeting.... We had a campfire and a big pot of corned beef and cabbage so that we could have an early meeting and not go hungry. We were discussing the original purposes that Dr. Ashe and I dreamed in physics lab that day when he said ‘I expect you to see that things don’t get out of control!’ This I was doing.”⁷⁵



⁷⁵ - Houghtaling, Francis S., letter to the author, November 13, 1974.





Photo by W. Diffenderfer



Glades Hunting Camp. A painting by James Hutchinson





“Here and there a scrap of paper would emerge, only to disappear again.”
The original petition for official University recognition, 1927.



Courtesy of N. Ted Kennedy



The Founding Nine. “It is with an effort to establish a worthwhile tradition that may be successfully carried on down through the years, and of forming into a group those men who are representative of the spirit of the University in the highest degree, and who will be influential in the life of the institution, that we, the undersigned, ask that ‘Iron Arrow’ be allowed to take root and grow.”

Standing: Leonard M. Tuttle, Gavin S. Millar, Clarke B. Wilson, Francis S. Houghtaling, John C. McGuire. Kneeling: Dale R. Clark, Harry Gray, Norman Ted Kennedy, Bob Fink.





Photo by Franklin A. Robinson



Tony Tommie, “the late Chief of the Seminoles, made all members of the organization official members of the Seminole Nation.”





Photo by J. Warren



“The drum pulse continued quietly into a world torn with war; it beat strongly beside each ritual fire of the fifties; it kept its haunting vigil through every year of man’s great race to reach the moon.”

Photo by C. R. Warren



“A few sticks of wood are placed in the Firebowl and lighted. Soon the smell of smoke begins to drift across the campus. It is Tapping Day.”





Photos - Ibis, 1927



Francis S. Houghtaling. Dr. Ashe walked into physics lab, climbed onto a high lab stoll next to Francis Houghtaling, and said, "I have talked to Howard Southgate about your idea of a Seminole ritual for a tap society for men."



Leonard M. Tuttle, grandson of Julia Tuttle; first Chief of Iron Arrow.





Photo by W. Diffenderfer



A tapping line, "in search of tradition's future."
February, 1976, tapping line: John Hartman with Arrow.

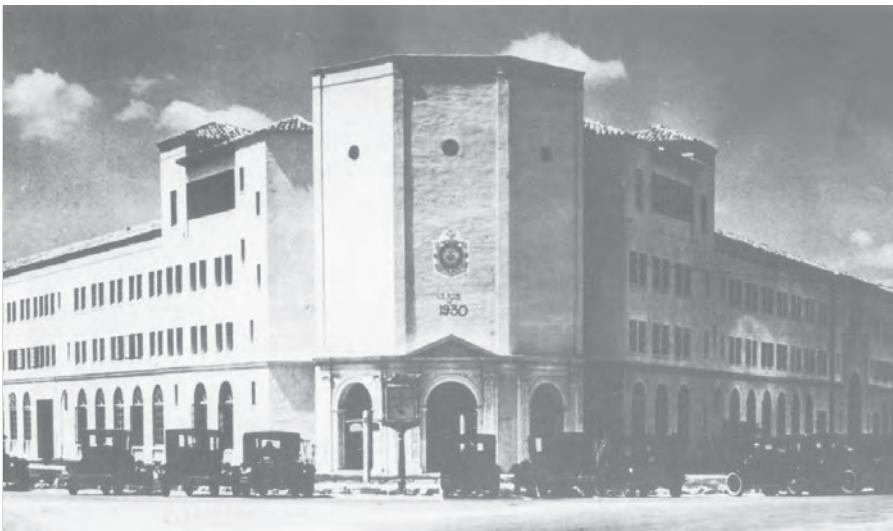




Photo by W. Diffenderfer



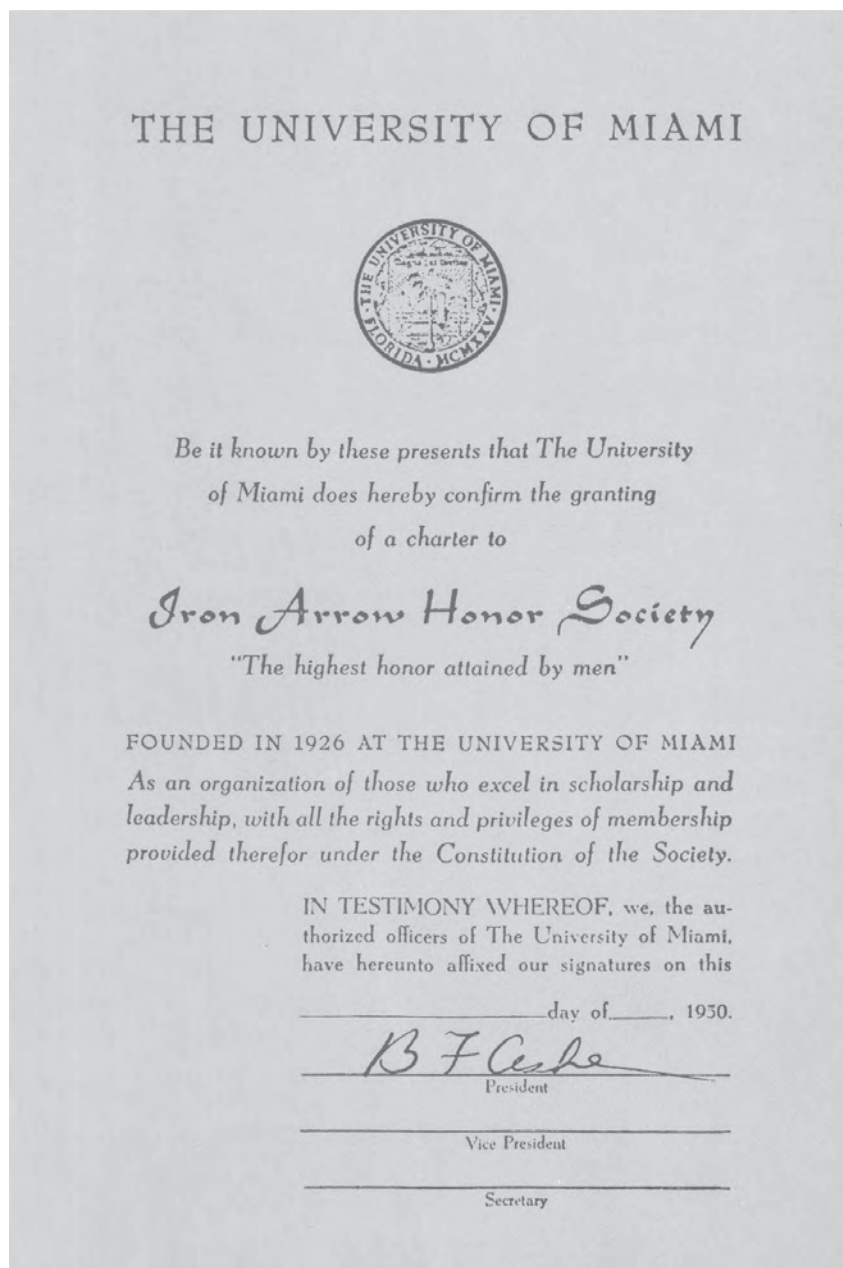
“Then weave for us a garment of brightness; May the warp be the white light of morning; May the weft be the red light of evening; May the fringes be the falling rain; May the border be the standing rainbow.” -Tewa-



The Cardboard College. “We marched down the hall to the stairs of the Rotunda and up to our room which was the first balcony four stories up.” Anastasia Building pictured here was the first site of the University of Miami.



Photo by R. Femmer



"The birthright blessings of the University belonged to Iron Arrow, its first-born." Iron Arrow's charter is the only such document to be signed by President Ashe.



Photo by T. Koch



Howard Osceola. Tapping luncheon, Homecoming, 1974. Osceola's village makes the Seminole jackets worn by Iron Arrow. The photograph of his grandparents was presented to him by the Tribe.



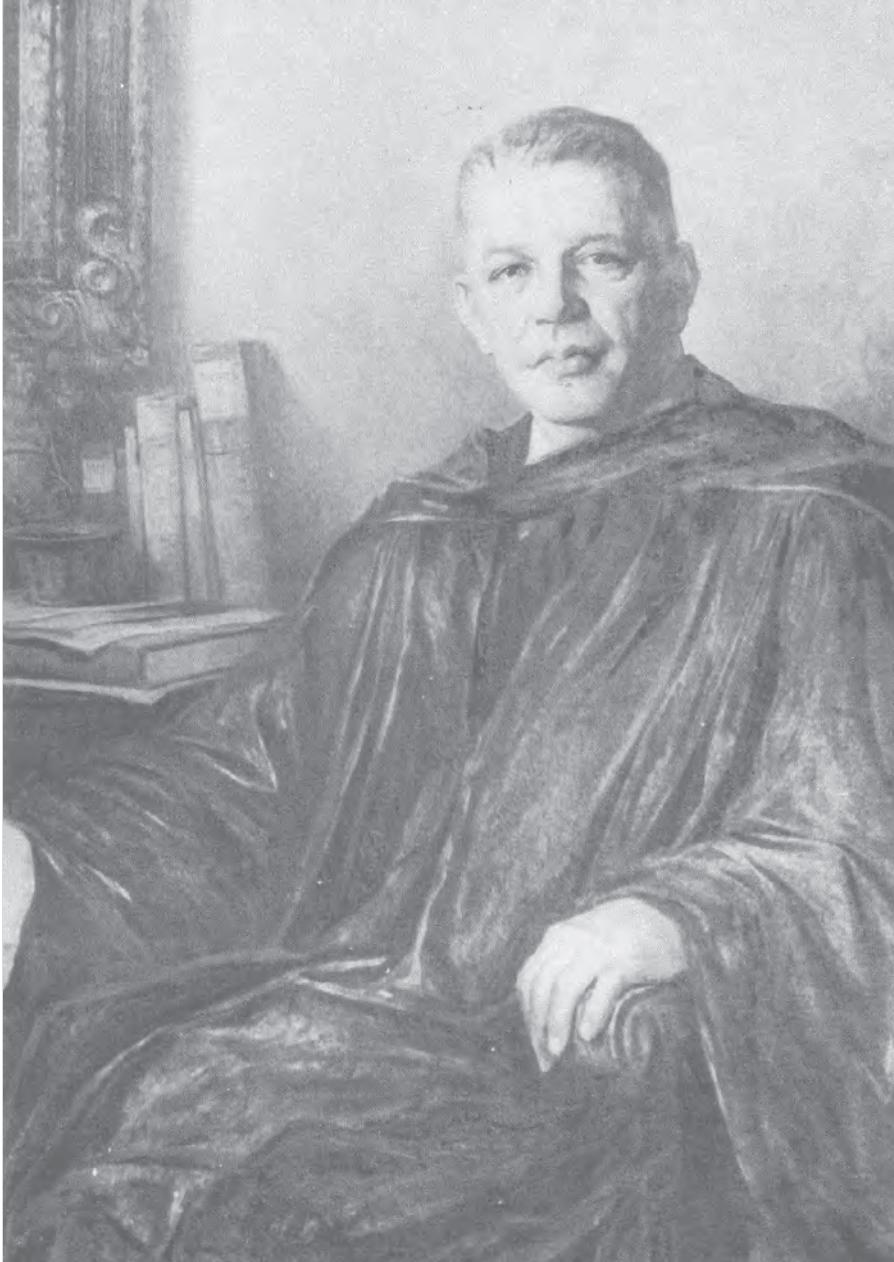
Photo by T. Koch



“... I felt certain that it (a bronze ‘shield shaped plaque’) was valuable and still important, even after four years of World War II.” Thurston Adams, first recipient of the Bowman Foster Ashe In-Memoriam Honor, November, 1975.



Photo by W. Diffenderfer



Bowman Foster Ashe. "Since we were a new University we could chart our course like a surveyor using a compass and transit to make a straight course, with a shorter path for traditions."





Photo - UM Archives



“ . . . the sounds of the ceremonies are the sounds of the Florida wilderness.”
Marshal Shapo, Alan Rodberg with Arrow, and Leroy Howe with drum. From
Homecoming Hurricane, 1957.

Photo by W. Diffenderfer



The Arrow, “in flight made a stright course.” Used in tapping; used in ritual;
symbol of Iron Arrow.





Courtesy of C. Fromhagen



“We determined to rejuvenate the society to the active group Dr. Ashe had originally envisioned.” Clive Shrader, Carl Fromhagen.

Photos by W. Diffenderfer



1927



1926



1976





Jay F. W. Pearson, second President of the University of Miami tapped as sponsor of Iron Arrow, October 5, 1953. Left to right: Jerry Kogan, Fritz Richter, J.F.W. Pearson, Wayne Whisler (with Arrow), and Roger Walker.



Photo - UM Archives



President Henry King Stanford, third sponsor of Iron Arrow, here being tapped
November 10, 1966.



Photo by T. Koch



Stubborn Rudders. "About to embark without a rudder into a turbulence unmatched in such a concentrated span of time." Chiefs Rhea Warren, John Leatherwood, and John Benedict served for seven consecutive years.

Photo - (c) *National Geographic*



The famous 1950 photograph which appeared in *National Geographic* magazine. Reproduced courtesy of *National Geographic*.
First row: Bob Yoxall, Carl Cohen, Leonard De Longa, Bob Gelberg. Second row: Thomas Bottomley, Carl Fromhagen, Art Sacy, Art Grace, Clive Shrader, Holmes Braddock, H. Franklin Williams, Frazier Payton, Thurston Adams.



Photo by T. Koch



“... our works are considered masterpieces in clothing.” Medicine Man's jacket, sash, and turban, given to Iron Arrow in 1974 by the village of Howard Osceola.





Josie Billie With Seminole Wheel of Life. Painting by James Hutchinson.

Photo - UM Archives (Reprinted by permission of the University of Miami)



Oseola. "... the dark, subdued colors reflect not the glaring intensity of a Florida sun, nor the dancing shadows and light of a council fire. . . "



Photo by T. Koch

Ashe In-Memoriam Honor. “The likeness of Bowman Foster Ashe upon an arrowhead suspended by a ribbon of orange, green, and white.” For distinguished service to Iron Arrow.

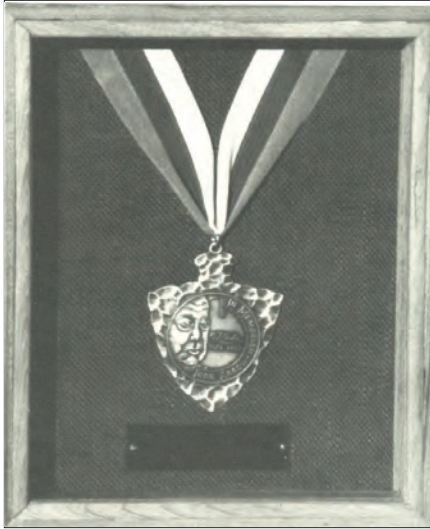


Photo - UM Archives

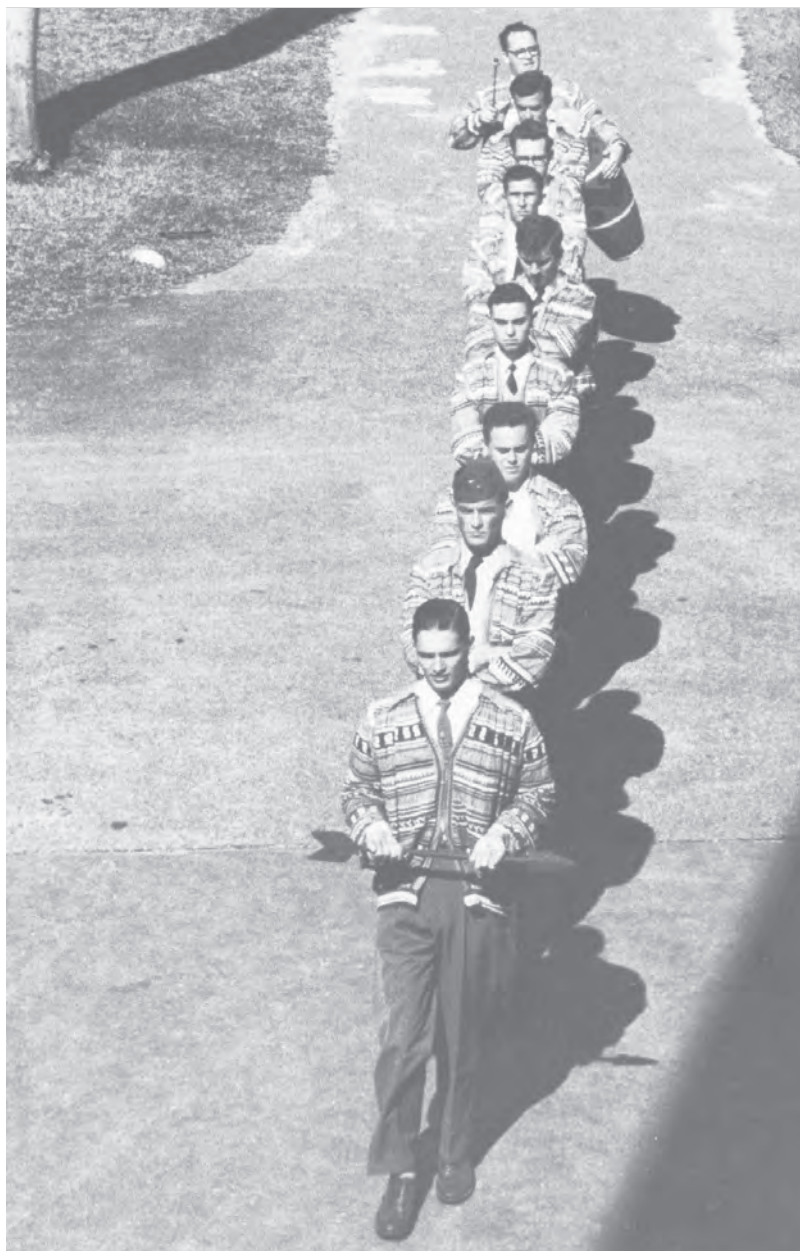


Ashe Building Rededication. Homecoming, November 12, 1970. “Passing that statue, you might meditate a moment upon the spirit it represents.” Chief John Leatherwood, Mrs. Bowman Foster Ashe, and President Henry King Stanford. Jacket on statue originally belonged to Dr. Ashe.





Photo - UM Archives



Homecoming 1954. Pictured from front are: Fritz Richter, Bill Allen, Jerry Kogan, Robert Powell, George Smith, Earl Welbaum, William Clark, Jerry Herman, and Wayne Whisler with drum.





Photo - UM Photo Center



Iron Arrow taps Henry Field, noted anthropologist, and Chuck Foreman, football All-American, epitomize Iron Arrow diversity. Background: Steven Hill, William Littleman.

Photo - UM Archives

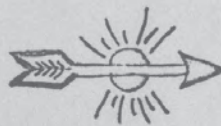


Tapping line, January 1950. (Left-right): Clive Shrader, Holmes Braddock, Paul Nagel, James Thomas, Lew Caputa, and Leonard De Longa.





Courtesy of Cushman L. Robertson



Another moon on your journey down life's trail
has passed, and you have proved yourself to be deserving
of high recognition for contributing to our University
those qualities of greatest value which shall endure
throughout life. Because of this accomplishment you
are hereby honored by "IRON ARROW".

This invitation extends to you the congratulations of
"IRON ARROW", the Honorary Fraternity of the University
of Miami.

Formal initiation will be conducted Sunday evening at
nine p.m.. The tribe will assemble at the University
Rotunda.

This bid is secret until public announcement after
initiation.

Cushman L. Robertson Chief.

Bid to membership - circa 1932.





Photo by Ray Fisher



Chief Lory Snipes presenting tapping jackets, January, 1951.

Photo - UM Photo Center



Charlie Charlton and Ted Peck assist Thomas Davison with his tapping jacket, Homecoming, 1969.





Photo - UM Archives



Main campus as it appeared in January, 1950. Chief Clive Shrader and Ken DeLonga welcome Whitey Campbell.





Photo - UM Photo Center

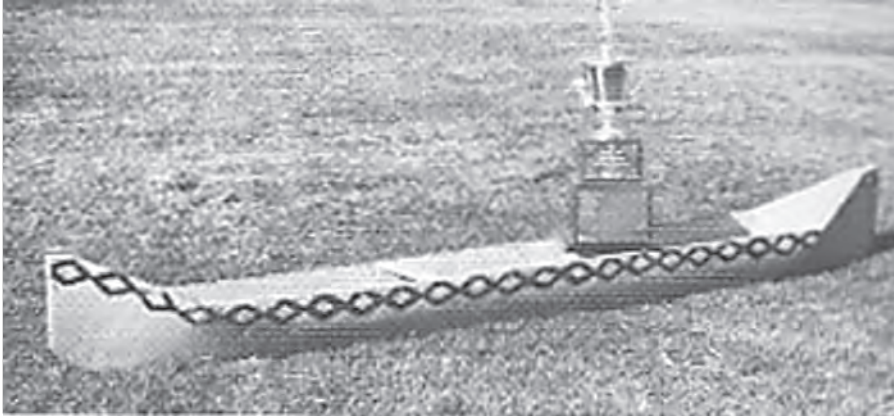


Iron Arrow Drum Vigil. Chuck Foreman and Tom Turchetta keep watch over University traditions, Homecoming, 1971.





Photo by W. Diffenderfer



Cypress War Canoe and Osceola Cup.

Photo - UM Photo Center



“... the colored jackets and the solemn, primitive rhythm of the drum break the morning’s spell.” Charlie Charlton leads November, 1970, tapping line with tappees Blake King, Emmanuel Nicolaides, Aly Dadras and Agustin Recio.

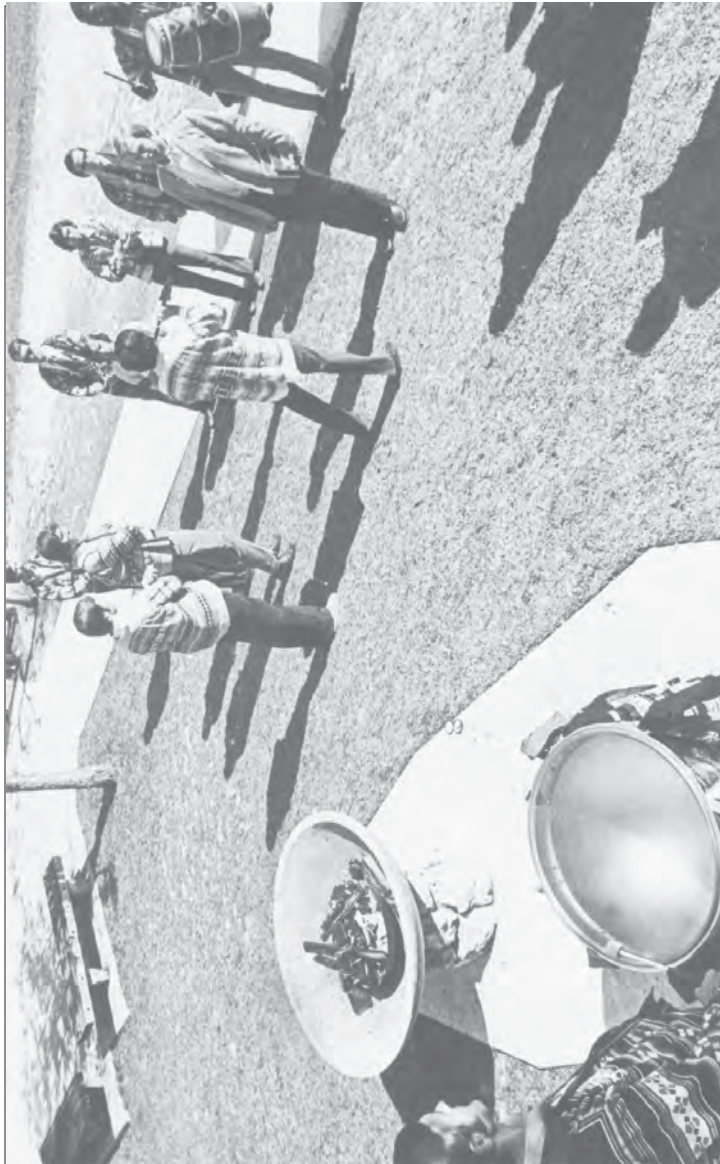


Photo by Dan Phifer



Homecoming Parade, 1972. (Front, left - right): John Benedict, Doug Phifer. (Back, left - right): Katie Warren, C. Rhea Warren, John E. Leatherwood III, Steve Ackerman.

Photo by Steve Diehl



“You have been tapped into Iron Arrow.” Tappees stand before Chief C. Rhea Warren, March 16, 1972.



Photo by Dade W. Thornton



This was the forest primeval.

